



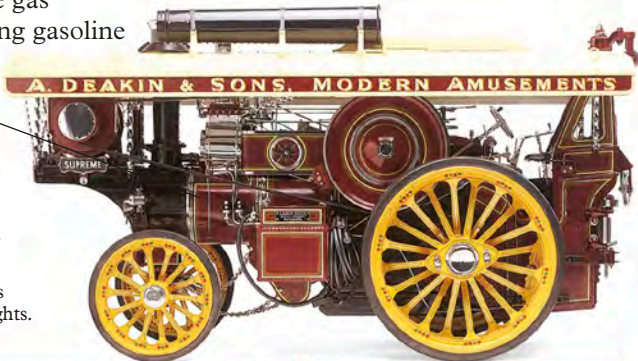
ENGINES AND MOTORS

Engines and motors provide power to make things move. Motors usually run on electricity, and often drive small things, such as fans or hairdryers. Engines are usually more powerful, and run on heat. In steam engines—the first real engines—heat boils water to make steam, and the steam pushes the engine around, just as steam in a pan of boiling water pushes up the lid. Cars have “internal combustion” engines. In these, the engine is pushed around by the gas produced from burning gasoline inside the engine.

Boiler to make steam

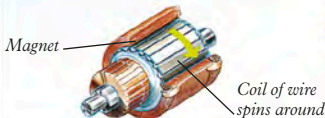
Letting off steam

Brightly colored steam traction engines like this one were often seen at fairgrounds up until around the middle of the 20th century. The steam traction engine drove the rides and made electricity for the lights.



Electric power

Electric motors work by magnetism. An electric current passing through a coil of wire turns the coil into a very powerful magnet. If the coil is set between another magnet, it is driven around at great speed to power machines, such as your hairdryer.



Jet power

Most modern airplanes have jet engines. These push a blast of hot air out of the back, which drives the plane forward at enormous speed.

